

Metro Parks Starter Card

This is the **system card** — how to use Central Ohio parks without overthinking.
For specific under-\$15 outings, see the Nature guide; this card is the orientation layer.

Not affiliated with park districts. Hours, alerts, and rules change.

Pick a park in 60 seconds

If you have...	Choose...
40 minutes	Small lake loop / neighborhood metro park
90 minutes	One trail + overlook; leave when the timer ends
Half day	One larger park; pack water; don't hop three lots
Kids / stroller	Paved or crushed stone loops first
Dogs	Confirm leash rules and which parks allow pets

Before you go

- ☐ Check park alerts (flooding, closures, hunts where applicable)
- ☐ Screenshot a map — signal dies in pockets of woods
- ☐ Water + one layer more than you think
- ☐ Tell someone your lot + return time for longer hikes

Etiquette that keeps parks nice

- Stay on marked trails near bluffs and sensitive prairie
- Leash where required; pack out waste
- Headphones low enough to hear bikes/horses where shared
- No “shortcut” social-media bushwhacking

Gear minimum

Season	Minimum
Any	Water, phone, keys, map screenshot
Summer	Bug spray, sunscreen, tick check plan
Winter	Traction shoes, gloves, daylight deadline
After rain	Grip shoes — boardwalks get slick

Try-three tracker

#	Park	Date	Loop / trail	Would return?
1				Y/N
2				Y/N

3				Y/N
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Favorite so far: _____

Next to try: _____

Buckeye Trail Guide · Curated by Keith Householder · Columbus, Ohio
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